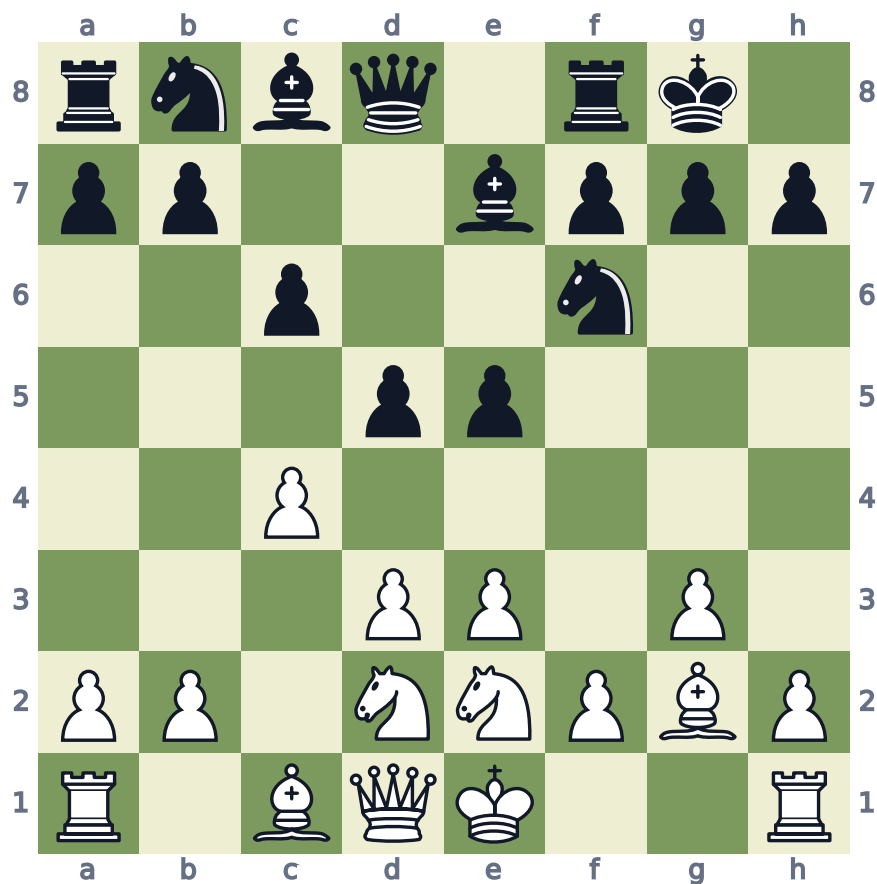


The White Hippo c4, f4, b4, and h4 Breaks

Queenside pressure, kingside expansion, pawn races, and central stability



Use White's wing breaks as structural tools rather than attacks launched from habit.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Use White's wing breaks as structural tools rather than attacks launched from habit.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

c4 attacks d5 and often creates a useful queenside majority.

PRINCIPLE 2

f4 attacks e5 but weakens the king and e3.

PRINCIPLE 3

b4 gains space only when the center cannot open against White.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

h4 can restrain or provoke a kingside fianchetto.

PRINCIPLE 5

Wing breaks should connect to an open file or a concrete target.

PRINCIPLE 6

The safest wing move may be to postpone it and complete central development.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

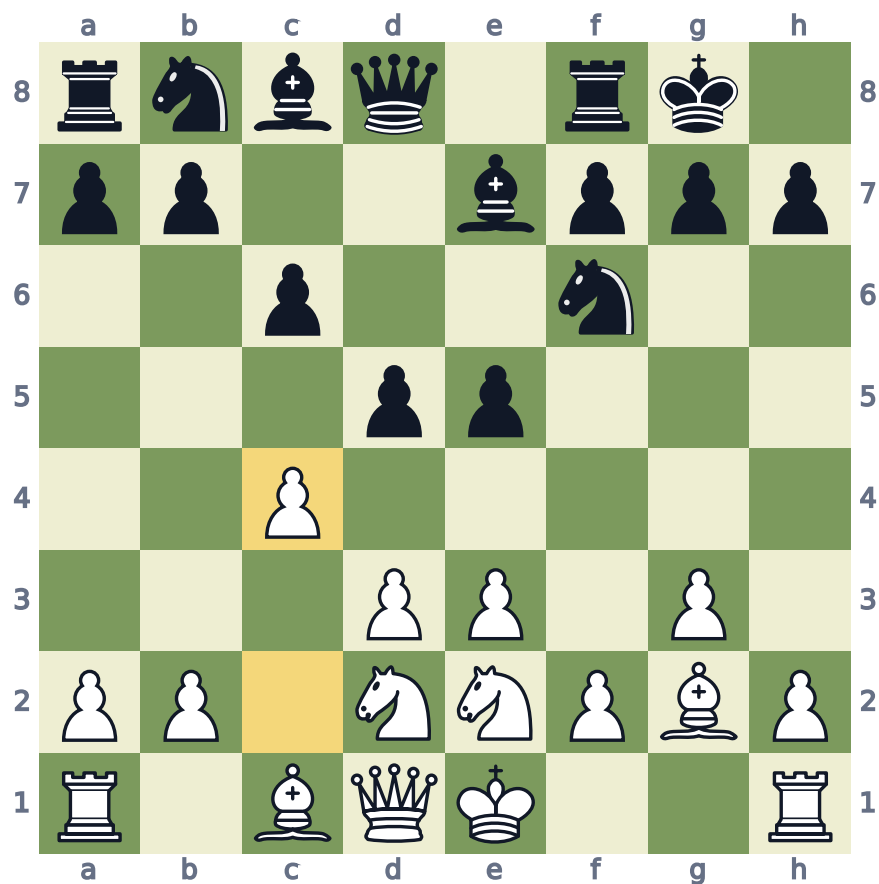
- | | | |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | c4 attacks d5 | c4 is a central lever played from the wing. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | c4 against mirrored fianchetto | Use c4 when d5 is the most valuable square. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | f4 against e5 | Prepare f4 with e4 and act before Black establishes d5. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | f4 in a King's Indian Attack | A pawn chain is strong only when its base and king are secure. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | b4 after central stability | b4 needs central stability, tactical support, and a useful file after exchanges. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | b4 against c5 | Before b4, secure the diagonal and count every attacker on b4 and c5. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | h4 restrains a fianchetto | h4 is useful when it fixes a target and does not delay the main break. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | When to postpone the wing | King safety outranks a wing break when central files may open. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

c4 attacks d5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. c4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

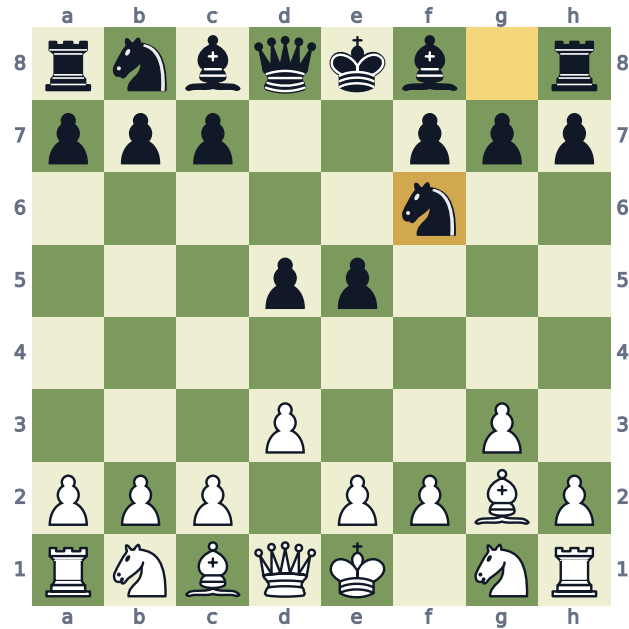
Challenge d5 and prepare queenside play through the c-file.

MAIN DANGER

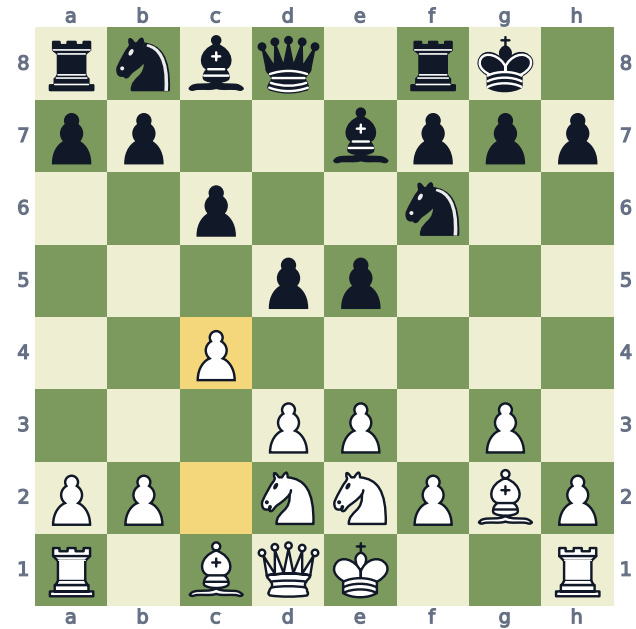
d4 can gain space and target c4.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

c4 is a central lever played from the wing.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.05 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bf5 e4 2. dxe4 dxe4 3. Be6 O-O 4. Na6 a3 5. Nc5 Qc2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

c4 attacks d5



YOUR TASK

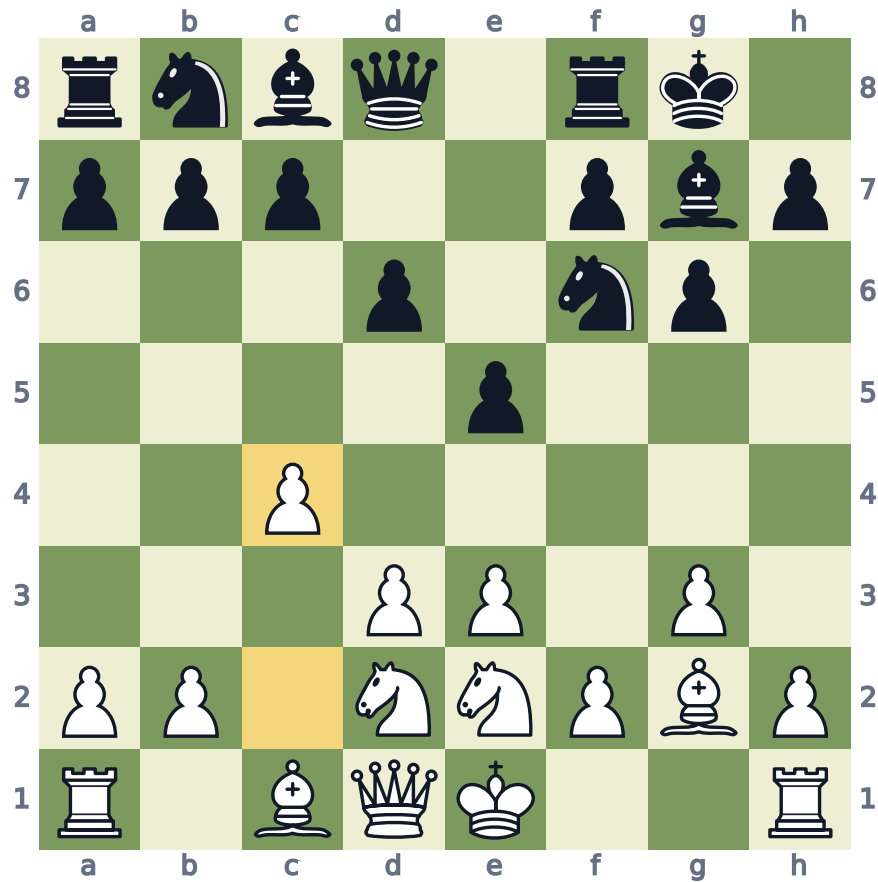
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

c4 against mirrored fianchetto



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. c4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

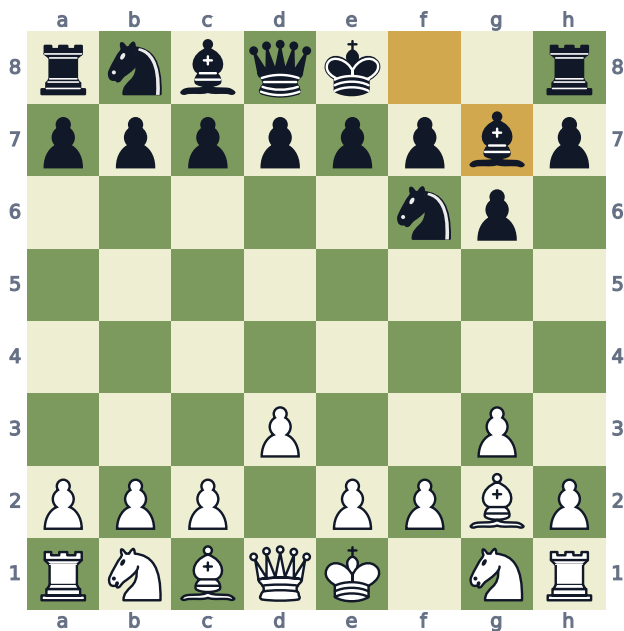
Control d5 and create an English-style bind.

MAIN DANGER

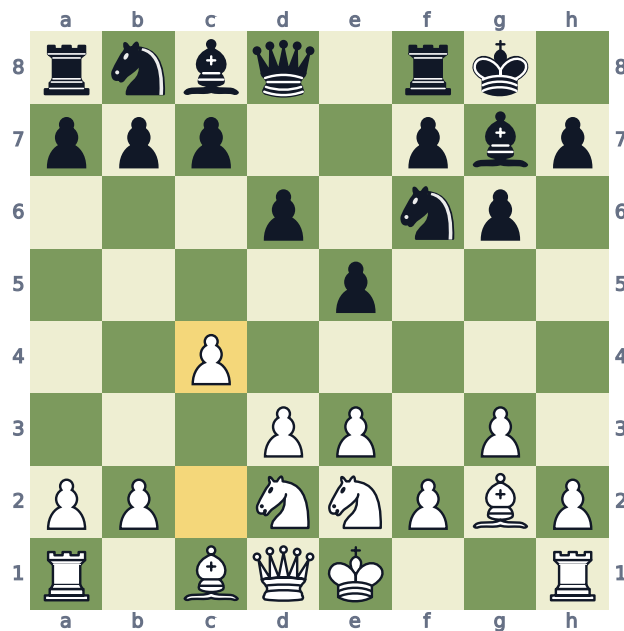
c6 and d5 can equalize if White is slow.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Use c4 when d5 is the most valuable square.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

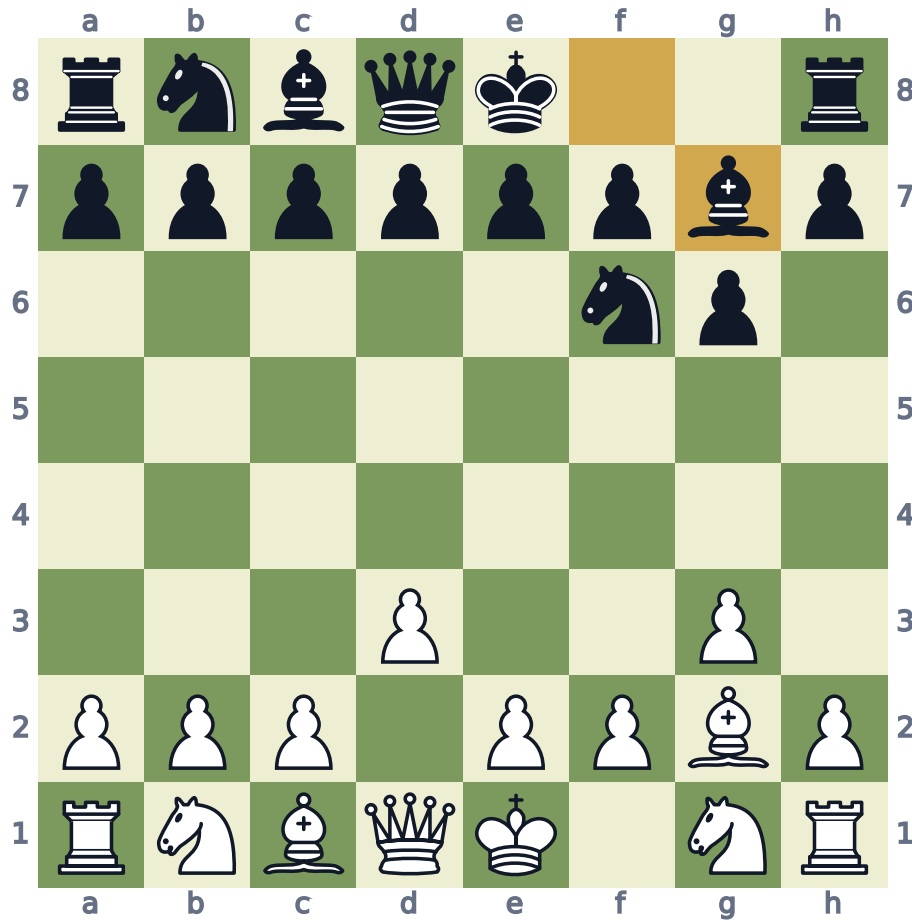
Position estimate: -0.31 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 b3 2. c6 O-O 3. Na6 Ba3 4. Nb4 Ne4 5. Nxe4 dxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

c4 against mirrored fianchetto



YOUR TASK

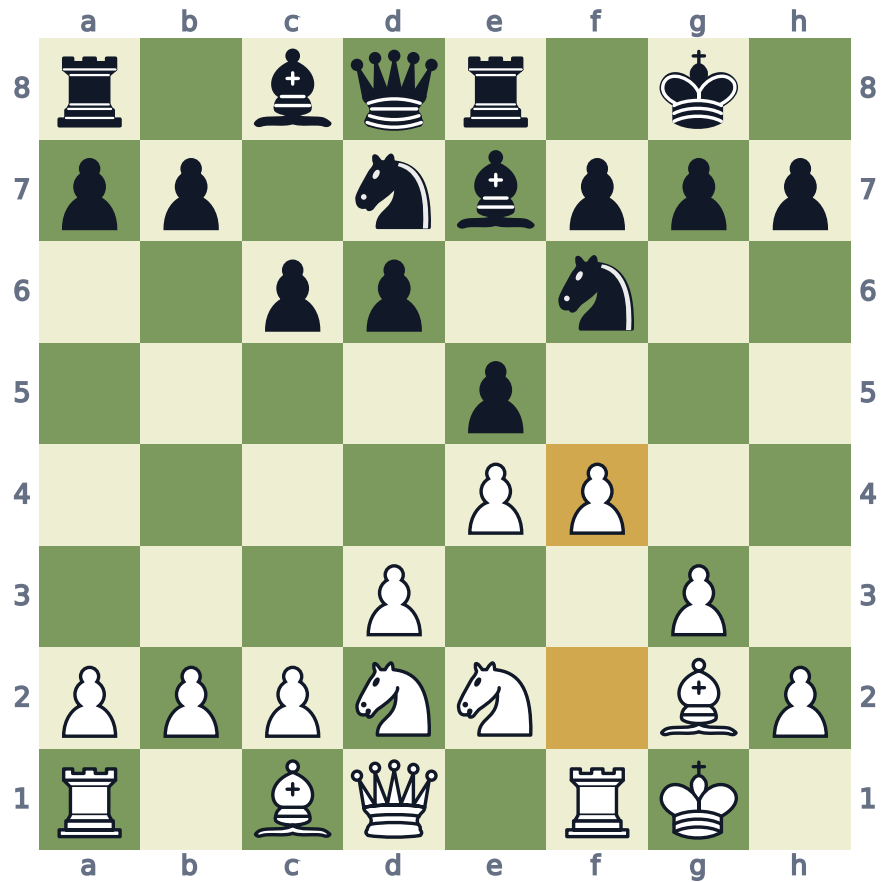
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

f4 against e5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 d6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. O-O Re8 8. e4 Nbd7 9. f4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

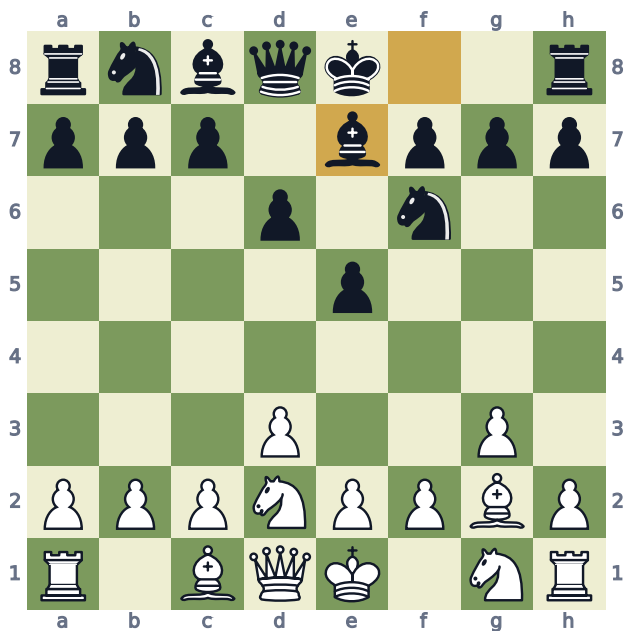
Build the e4-f4 chain against Black's compact center after castling.

MAIN DANGER

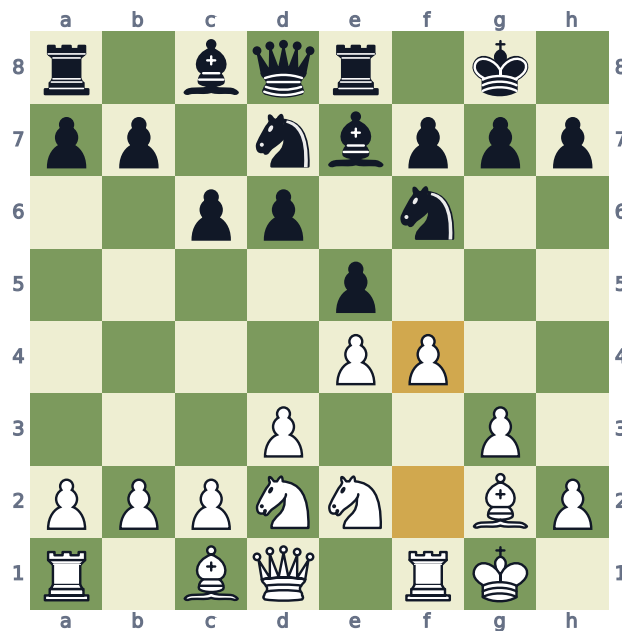
exf4 opens lines and may expose White's king.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Prepare f4 with e4 and act before Black establishes d5.

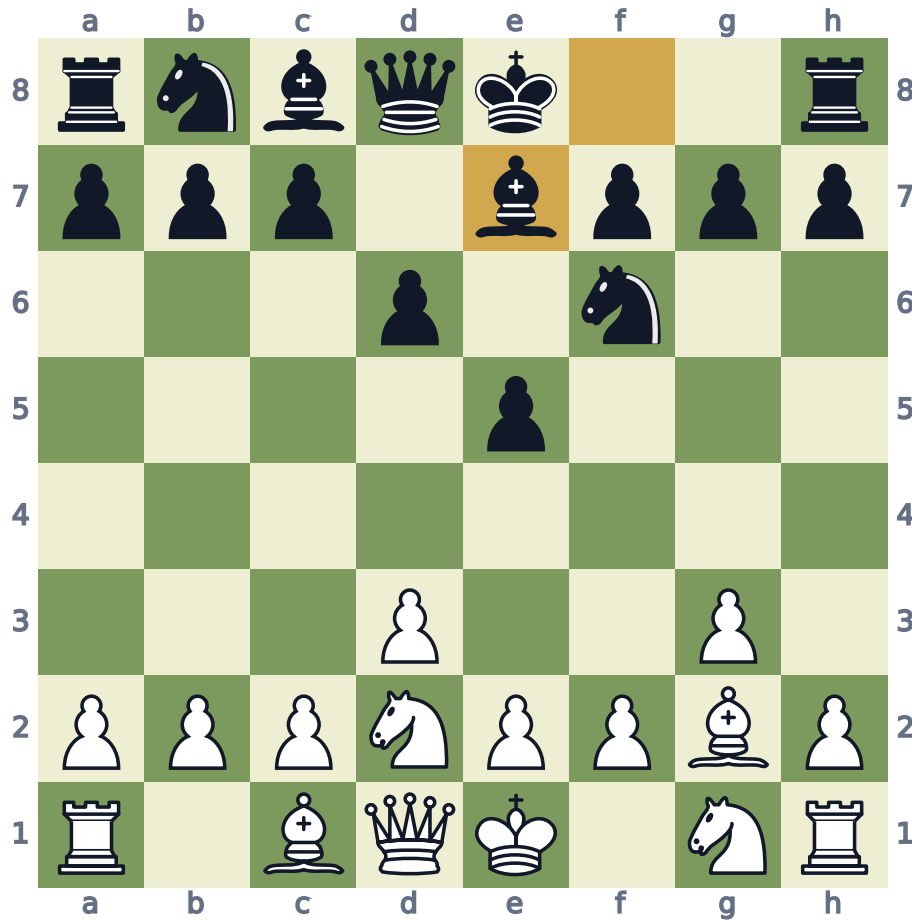
ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.56 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 Nc3 2. dxe4 Ndx4 3. exf4 Bxf4 4. Nxe4 Nxe4 5. Nf6 Kh1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

f4 against e5**YOUR TASK**

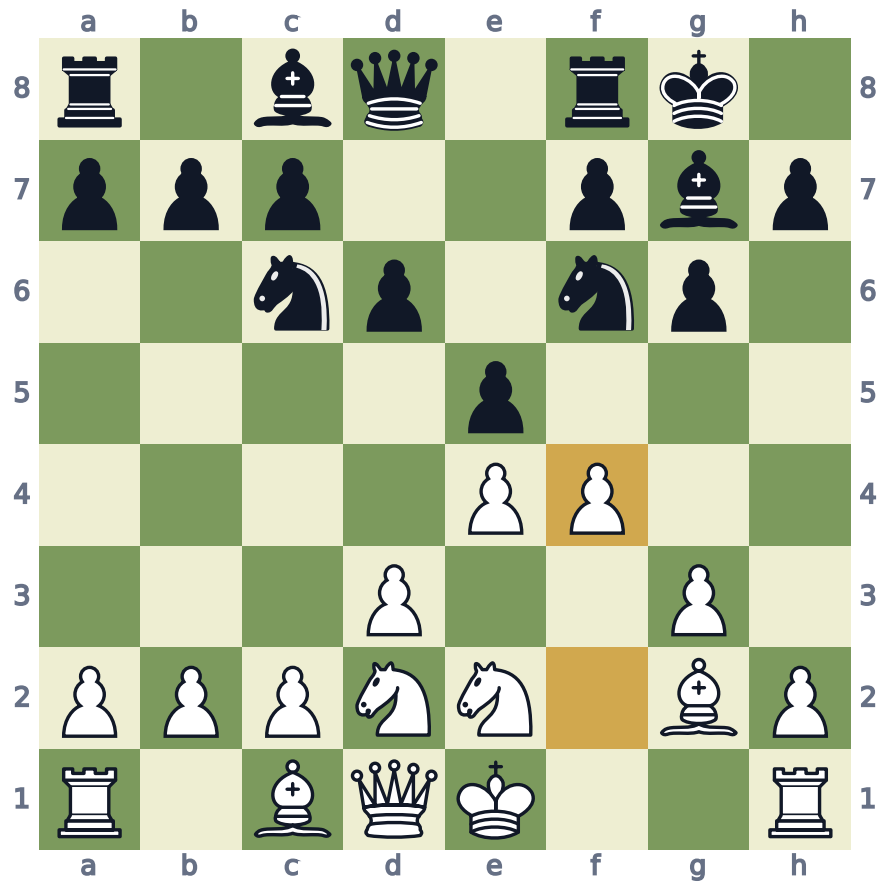
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

f4 in a King's Indian Attack



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. e4 Nc6 8. f4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

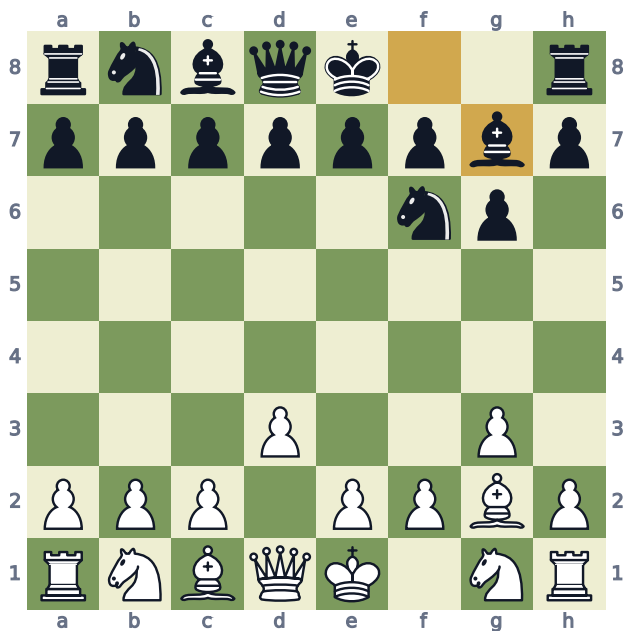
Build the e4-f4 chain and prepare f5 after development.

MAIN DANGER

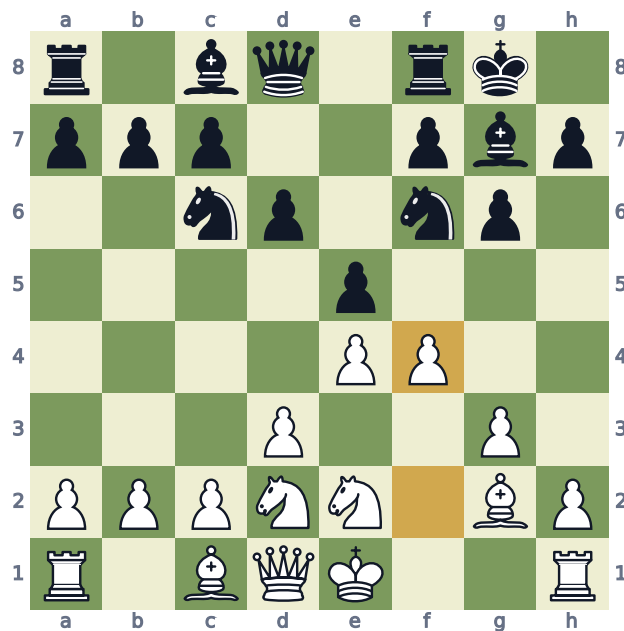
exf4 or d5 can attack the center before f5.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A pawn chain is strong only when its base and king are secure.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

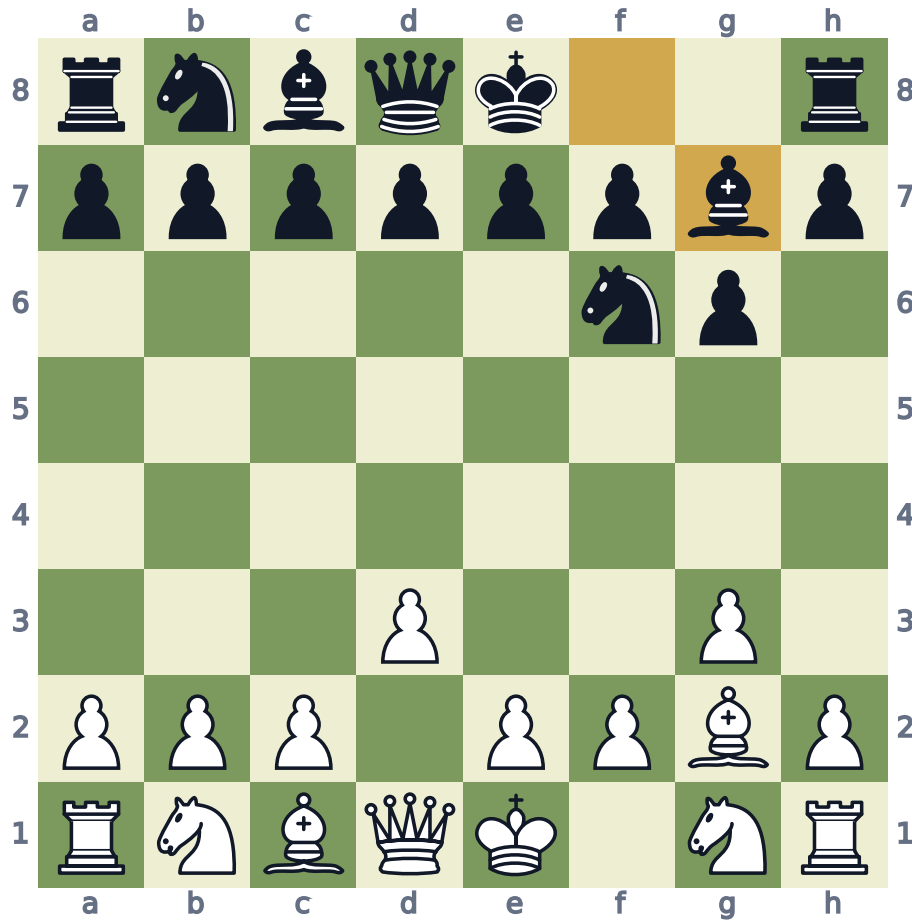
Position estimate: -1.11 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 O-O 2. exf4 gxf4 3. dxe4 dxe4 4. Bg4 Nf3 5. Qxd1 Rxd1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

f4 in a King's Indian Attack



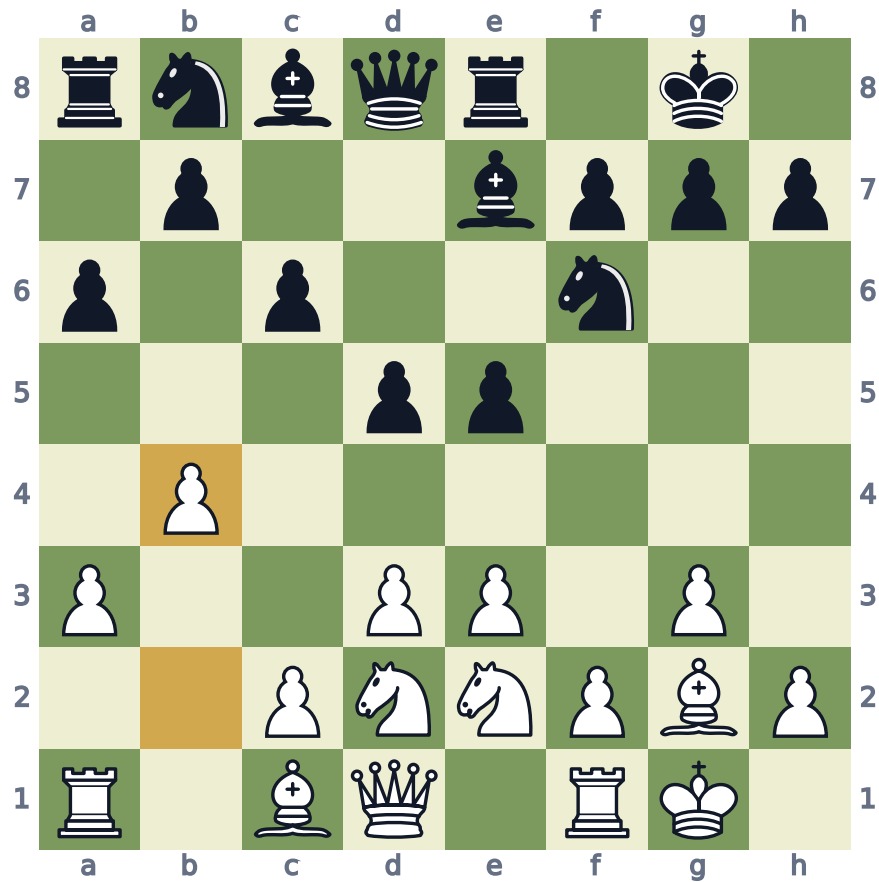
YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

b4 after central stability**COURSE LINE**

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. O-O a6 8. a3 Re8 9. b4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

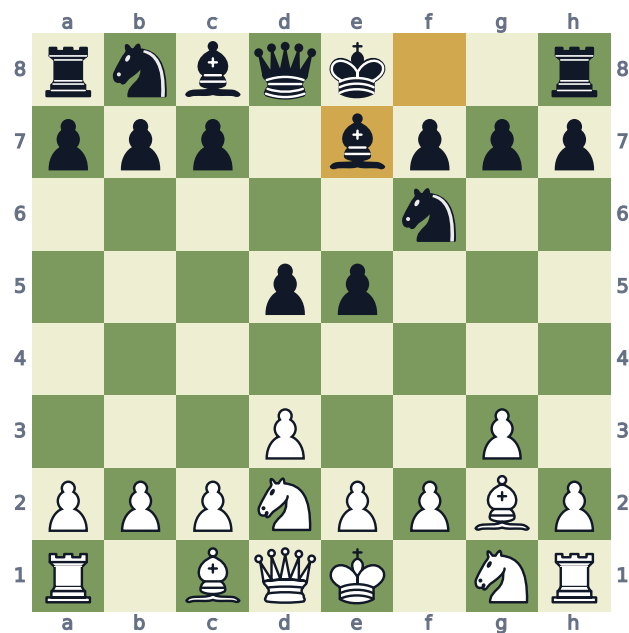
Gain queenside space after a3 and castling make the expansion more secure.

MAIN DANGER

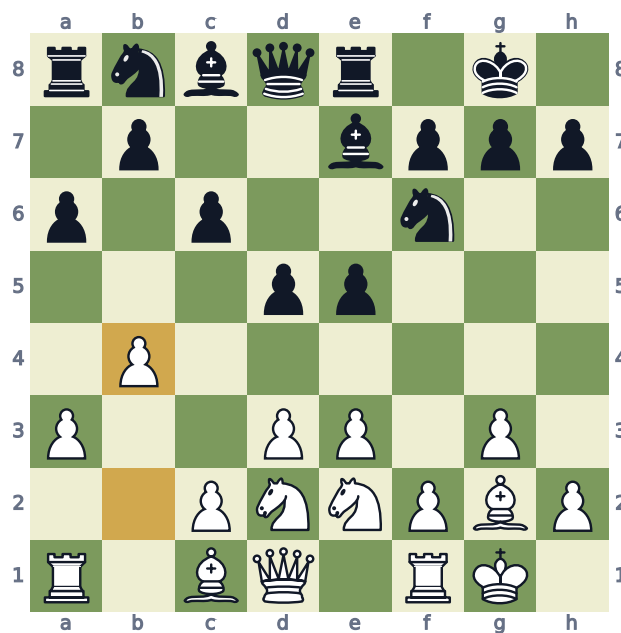
a5 can challenge the pawn chain on the next move.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

b4 needs central stability, tactical support, and a useful file after exchanges.

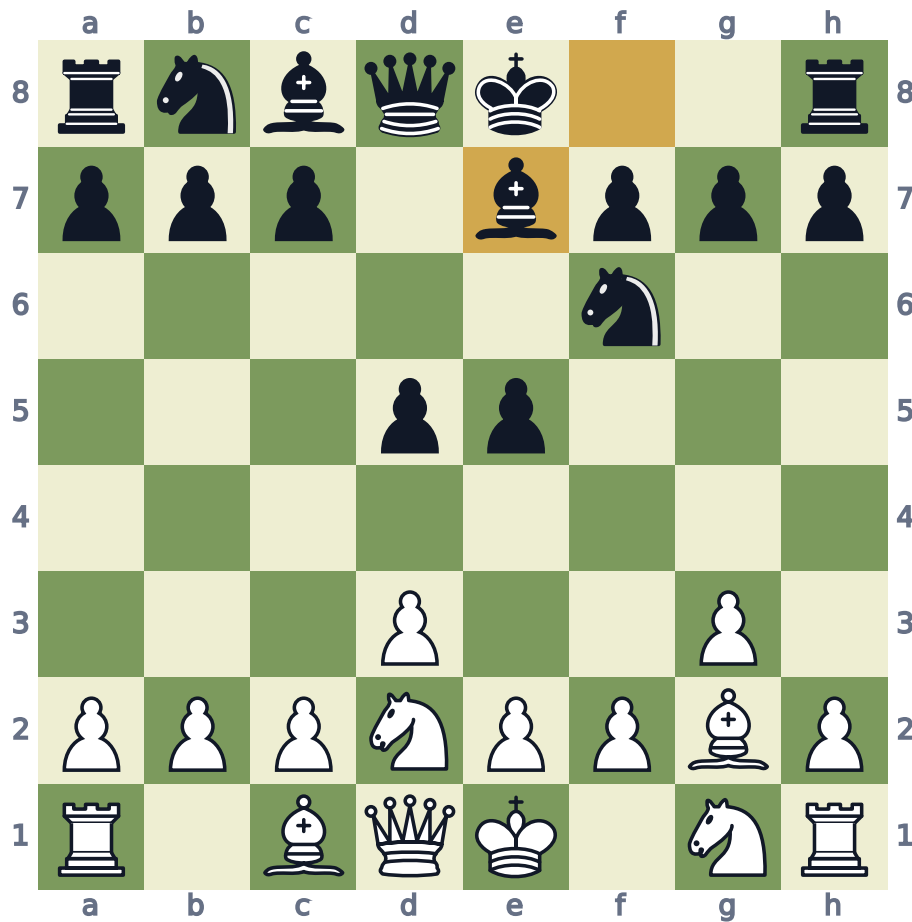
ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.59 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 Rb1 2. b5 Re1 3. h6 h3 4. axb4 axb4 5. Bd6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

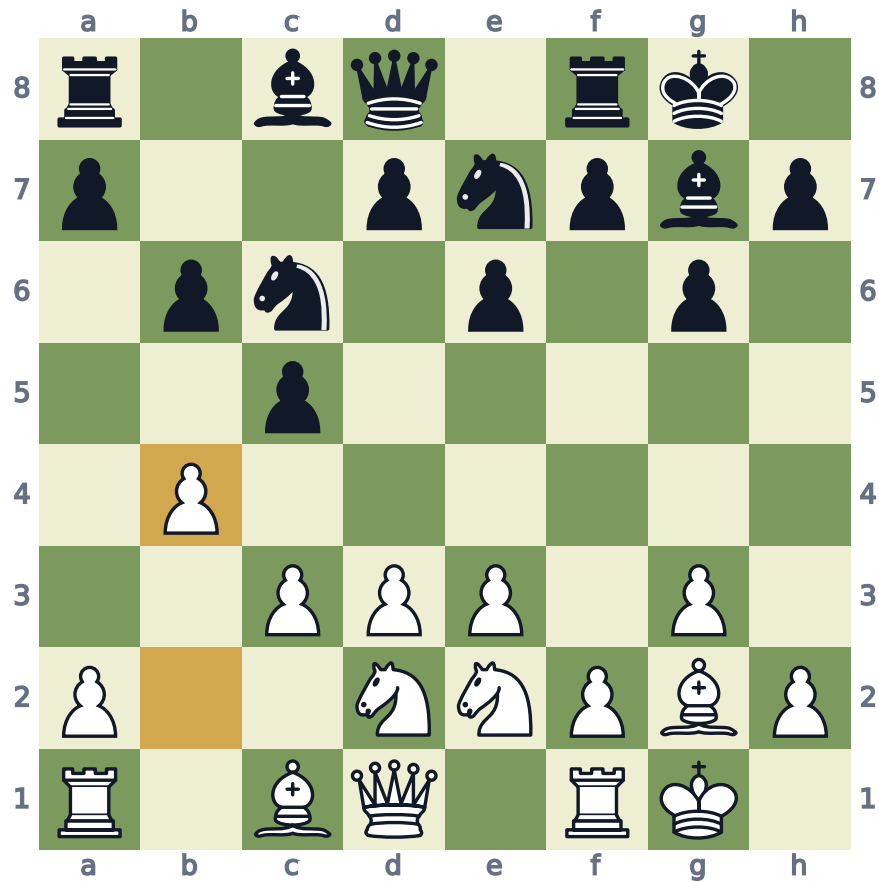
b4 after central stability**YOUR TASK**

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

b4 against c5**COURSE LINE**

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Nge7 7. O-O b6 8. c3 O-O 9. b4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

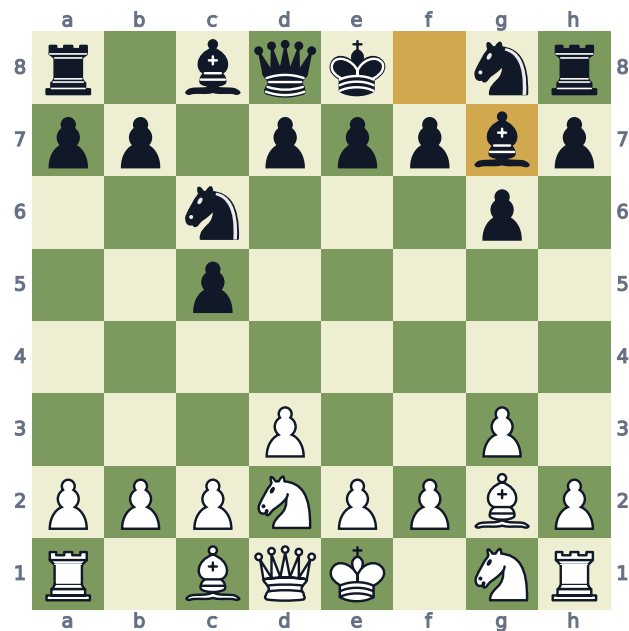
Use c3 to close the g7-a1 diagonal before moving the b-pawn.

MAIN DANGER

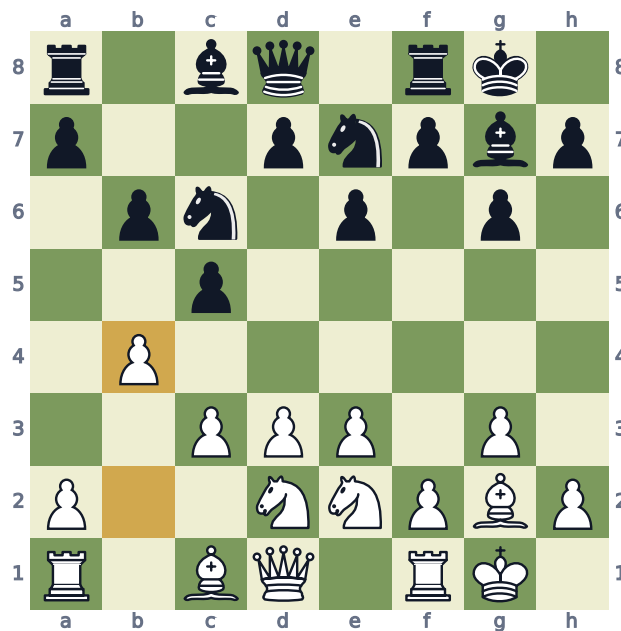
Nxb4 or cxb4 tactics can still lose a pawn.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Before b4, secure the diagonal and count every attacker on b4 and c5.

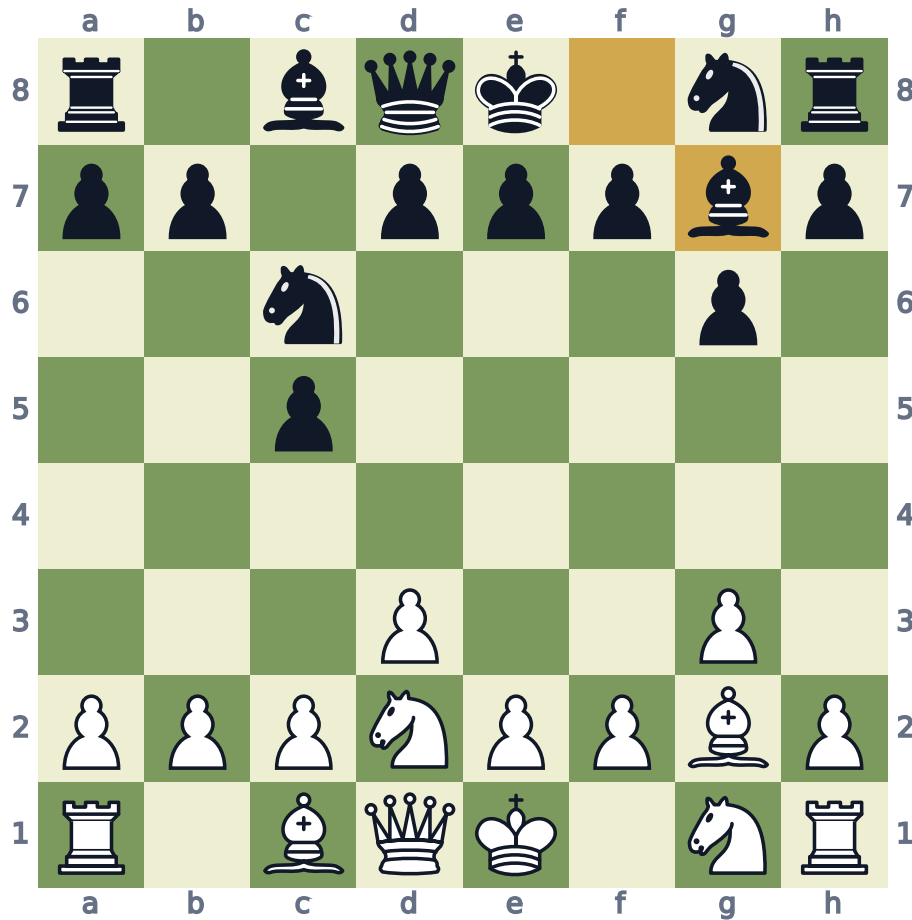
ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.17 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. cxb4 d4 2. d5 Rb1 3. bxc3 Nxc3 4. Ba6 Nb5 5. Bxb5 Rxb5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

b4 against c5**YOUR TASK**

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

h4 restrains a fianchetto



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. h4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

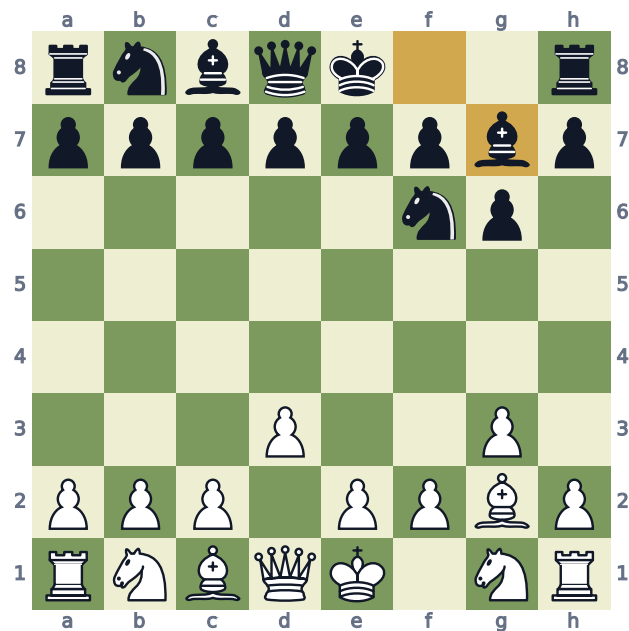
Gain space and prepare h5 only after the center and king are stable.

MAIN DANGER

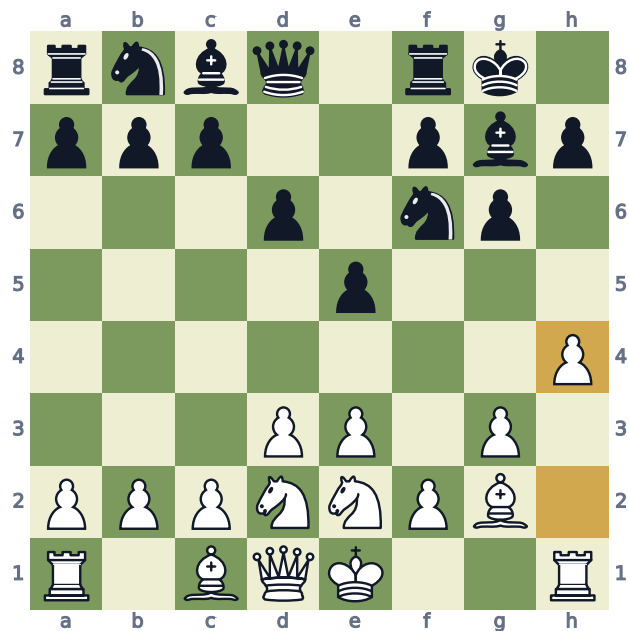
h5 can be met by a central strike or g5.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

h4 is useful when it fixes a target and does not delay the main break.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

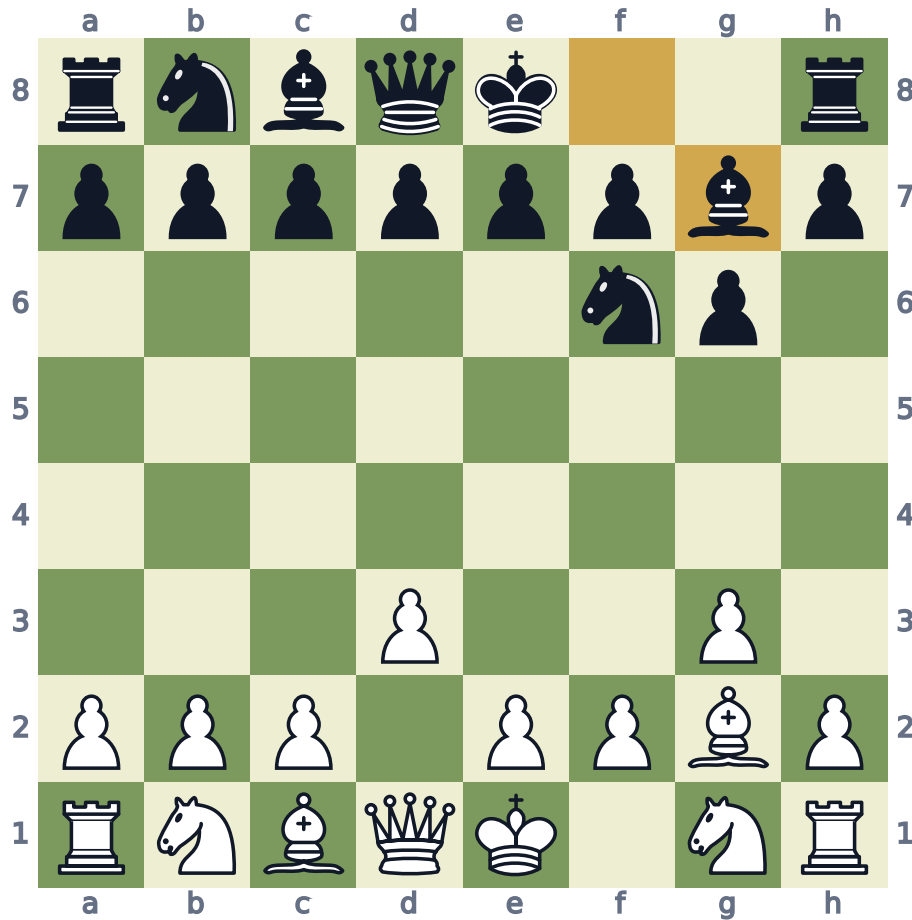
Position estimate: -0.71 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 O-O 2. d5 b3 3. Nc6 c4 4. Bg4 Bb2 5. d4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

h4 restrains a fianchetto



YOUR TASK

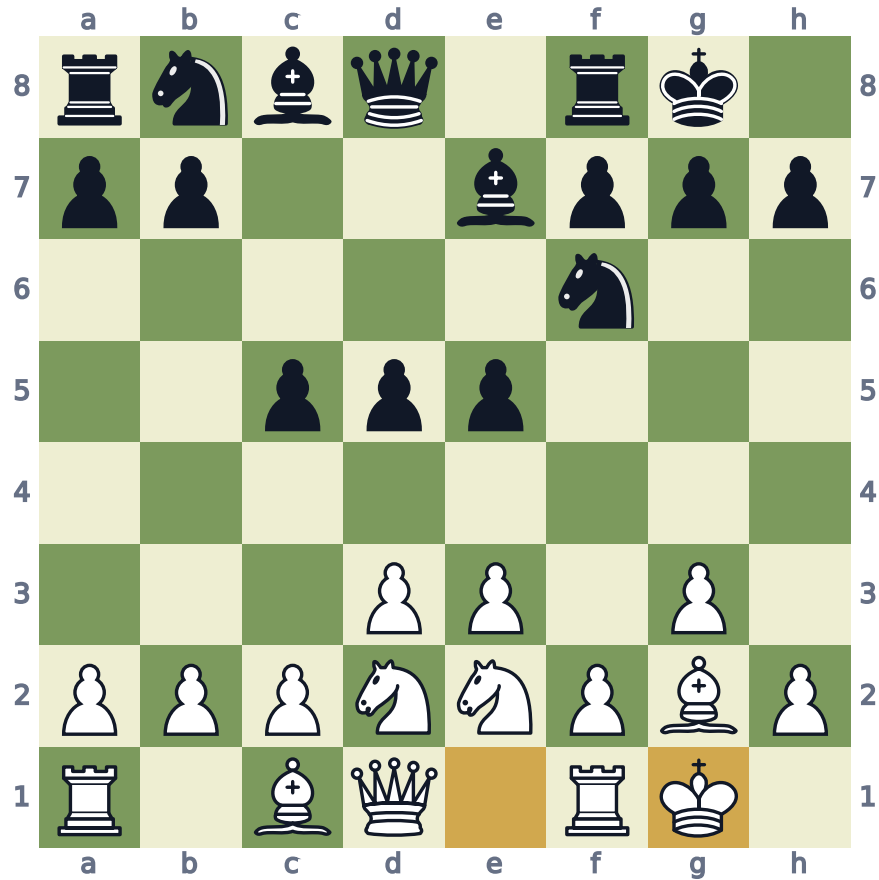
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

When to postpone the wing



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Castle instead of launching a wing pawn while the center remains under tension.

MAIN DANGER

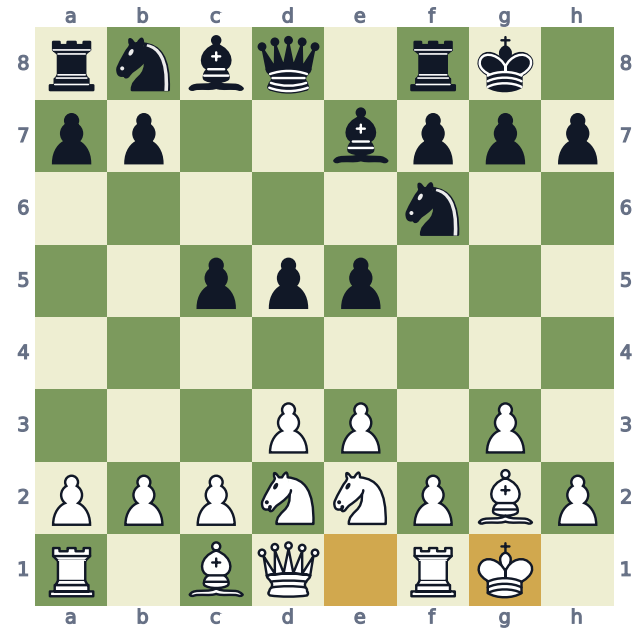
d4 or e4 can still gain space on the next move.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

King safety outranks a wing break when central files may open.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

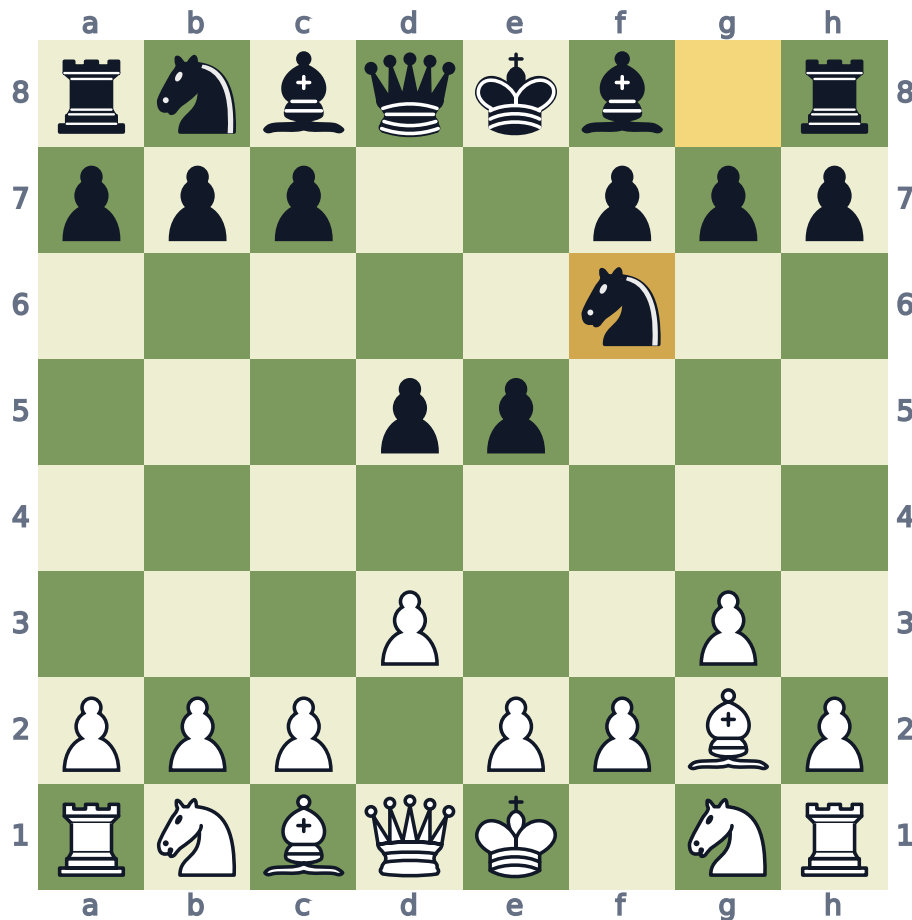
Position estimate: -0.54 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 d4 2. e4 dxc5 3. Bxc5 c4 4. dxc4 Nxc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

When to postpone the wing



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. C4 ATTACKS D5

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Challenge d5 and prepare queenside play through the c-file. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can gain space and target c4.

02. C4 AGAINST MIRRORED FIANCHETTO

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Control d5 and create an English-style bind. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: c6 and d5 can equalize if White is slow.

03. F4 AGAINST E5

Course move: e3. Purpose: Build the e4-f4 chain against Black's compact center after castling. Engine comparison: 1. Ngf3 c5 2. O-O Nc6 3. Nc4 h6 4. b3 Be6 5. a4 O-O (+0.13 for White (equal)). Warning: exf4 opens lines and may expose White's king.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. F4 IN A KING'S INDIAN ATTACK

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Build the e4-f4 chain and prepare f5 after development. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: exf4 or d5 can attack the center before f5.

05. B4 AFTER CENTRAL STABILITY

Course move: e3. Purpose: Gain queenside space after a3 and castling make the expansion more secure. Engine comparison: 1. Ngf3 Nc6 2. O-O a5 3. c3 a4 4. Qc2 O-O 5. e4 d4 (-0.38 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: a5 can challenge the pawn chain on the next move.

06. B4 AGAINST C5

Course move: e3. Purpose: Use c3 to close the g7-a1 diagonal before moving the b-pawn. Engine comparison: 1. Ngf3 Nf6 2. O-O O-O 3. e4 d5 4. Re1 dxe4 5. dxe4 Bg4 (-0.18 for White (equal)). Warning: Nxb4 or cxb4 tactics can still lose a pawn.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. H4 RESTRAINS A FIANCHETTO

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Gain space and prepare h5 only after the center and king are stable. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: h5 can be met by a central strike or g5.

08. WHEN TO POSTPONE THE WING

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Castle instead of launching a wing pawn while the center remains under tension. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 or e4 can still gain space on the next move.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.